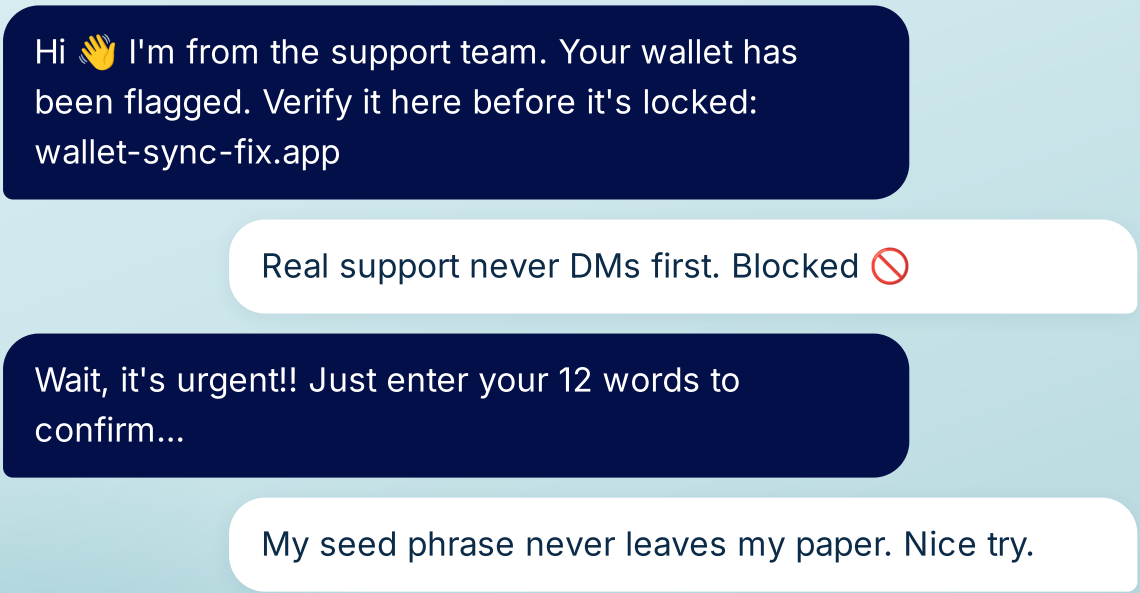
LOGTUN GUIDES · WEB3 BASICS

IAMLOGTUN

Wallet Safety 101

How to avoid drainers, fake DMs and scams. Plain-English rules for your wallet, your seed phrase and every pop-up you sign, plus checklists and what to do if you get hit.



by @iamlogtun

For beginners · Any wallet · Any chain

WELCOME

Start here

Most crypto losses don't come from "hacking". They come from one click, one signature or one message.

01 **Hot vs cold wallets**: what each is for, and a simple 3-wallet setup

02 **Seed phrase rules**: the one secret that controls everything

03 **Approvals & allowances**: what you've given away, and how to revoke it

04 **Signing safely**: connect vs sign vs transaction, and how to read a pop-up

05 **Drainer links & fake DMs**: how scammers reach you

06 **Fake airdrops & address poisoning**: the quiet scams in your own wallet

07 **Burner wallets & the pre-connect checklist**

08 **If you get compromised**: what to do, in order

09 **Cheat sheet**: the whole guide on one page

How to use this guide

- **Read Parts 1–4 once.** They explain how wallets actually lose money, so the scams later make sense.
- **Use the checklist in Part 7** every time you connect to a new site.
- **Save Part 8 now**, before you ever need it. When something goes wrong, minutes matter.
- **Screenshot the cheat sheet** and share it with friends who are new to crypto.

The golden rule

If someone or something asks for your **seed phrase**, it's a scam. Every time. No exceptions, no matter who they say they are.

Not financial advice

This guide is for education only. It's not financial advice, and no guide can make you 100% safe. Always do your own research (DYOR) and double-check before you sign anything.

PART 1

Hot vs cold wallets

Your wallet doesn't "hold" coins. It holds the keys that control them.

Every wallet is really a set of **keys**. Whoever controls the keys controls the funds. The difference between wallet types is simply **where those keys live** and how exposed they are to the internet.

HOT WALLET

An app or browser extension

Keys live on a device that's online (e.g. MetaMask, Phantom, Trust Wallet, Rabby). Free, fast and easy to use with apps.

Risk: if your device gets malware, or you sign a bad request, funds can be taken in seconds.

COLD WALLET

Keys kept offline

Usually a hardware wallet (e.g. Ledger, Trezor). You confirm each action by pressing buttons on the device itself.

Risk: it costs money and is slower. And it can't save you if *you* approve a malicious request.

A hardware wallet is not a magic shield

It stops malware from signing for you. It does **not** stop you from approving a drainer, or from typing your seed phrase into a fake site. Read the device screen before you press confirm.

The simple 3-wallet setup

You don't need to be an expert. Just stop using one wallet for everything.

VAULT

Long-term savings

Cold wallet if you can. Rarely connects to anything. Never used for new sites.

DAILY

Spending money

Hot wallet with small amounts, for trusted apps you use often.

BURNER

New & risky stuff

Mints, airdrops, quests, testnets, new sites. Holds almost nothing.

Buying a hardware wallet

- Buy only from the **official store** or an authorised seller. Avoid second-hand devices.
- If it arrives with a seed phrase already written on a card, **don't use it**. A real device creates your phrase during setup.
- Download its app only from the official website you typed in yourself.

PART 2

Seed phrase rules

12 or 24 words that are the master key to your wallet.

Your **seed phrase** (also called a recovery or secret phrase) can rebuild your whole wallet on **any device, anywhere**. If someone else gets it, they don't need your phone, your password or your permission. And it **can't be changed or reset**: once it's exposed, the only fix is moving to a brand-new wallet.

Password vs seed phrase

Your wallet app's **password** only unlocks the app on that one device. Your **seed phrase** is the real key. Losing the password is annoying; leaking the seed phrase is game over.

The 7 rules

1. **Write it on paper** (or stamp it on metal). Keep two copies in two safe places.
2. **Never store it digitally.** No screenshots, photos, notes apps, cloud drives, emails, or "sending it to myself" on WhatsApp.
3. **Never type it into a website**, form, Discord bot or "validate / sync / restore" page. The only place it ever goes is the official wallet app, when *you* chose to restore it.
4. **Nobody legit will ever ask for it.** Not support, not mods, not the wallet team, not an airdrop.
5. **Your private key is just as powerful** for that account. Same rules apply.
6. **Never paste it into an AI chat**, a translator or a "wallet checker" tool.
7. **Write it down privately.** No cameras around, no screen-sharing, no friend "helping".

× SCAM

```
"To receive your airdrop, verify
wallet ownership by entering your 12-
word phrase below."
```

✓ REALITY

```
No real airdrop, app or support team
needs your phrase. Ownership is proven
by signing in your wallet, never by
typing words.
```

Already typed it somewhere?

If you've ever entered your seed phrase into a website, form or chat, treat that wallet as **compromised**. Make a new wallet and move your funds (see Part 8).

PART 3

Approvals & allowances

The permissions you forgot you gave, and how to take them back.

When you swap, stake, bridge or list an NFT, the app usually asks you to **approve** its smart contract to move a token for you. That's normal. The problem: many apps ask for an **unlimited** amount, and the approval **stays active after you leave the site**, until you revoke it.

TOKEN APPROVAL

"Allow this site to spend your USDC"

Lets a contract move that token from your wallet, up to the limit you set (often "unlimited").

NFT APPROVAL

"Access all your NFTs in this collection"

Called **setApprovalForAll**. Gives a contract control over *every* NFT you hold in that collection.

If that contract is a scam, or a real app gets hacked later, it can use your old approval to take those tokens **without asking you again**.

How to check and revoke (revoke.cash)

1. Type **revoke.cash** into your browser yourself, or use a bookmark. Don't click links to it from DMs or ads.
2. **Paste your wallet address** to see your approvals. You only need to connect your wallet when you want to revoke.
3. Choose the **network** (Ethereum, Base, BNB Chain, etc.). Check each one you've used.
4. Look at each row: the **token**, the **spender** (who can move it) and the **amount**.
5. Click **Revoke** on anything you don't use or don't recognise, then confirm in your wallet.

Good to know

Each revoke is a small on-chain transaction, so it costs a little gas. Block explorers have similar tools too, such as Etherscan's Token Approval Checker. revoke.cash covers Ethereum and other EVM chains. On Solana, most drains come from signing a bad transaction, so Part 4 matters even more there.

Habits that keep you safe

- **Set a spending cap.** When your wallet lets you edit the amount, approve only what you need for this one action.
- **Do a monthly clean-up** of old approvals, especially on your daily wallet.
- **Revoke right away** if an app you used announces a hack.
- Remember: revoking **stops future** pulls. It can't bring back tokens already taken.

PART 4

Signing safely

Every wallet pop-up is a question. Know what you're saying yes to.

Pop-up	What it does	Risk
Connect	Lets the site see your address and balances. Can't move funds alone.	Low, but it's step one of every drain.
Sign a message	Free (no gas), off-chain. Often just a log-in.	**Can be high** (see below).
Transaction	On-chain action that costs gas: send, swap, approve, mint.	High if it's not what you expect.

"No gas" does not mean "safe"

Drainers love signature requests because they feel harmless. A **permit** signature can give someone permission to spend your tokens. A marketplace **listing** signature can sell your NFT for almost nothing. A long, unreadable block of code (blind signing) hides what you're agreeing to.

Normal vs dangerous: what you might see

✓ NORMAL SIGN-IN

```
site.xyz wants you to sign in.
"Welcome! This request will not cost
any gas fees."
Nonce: 8f3k2…
```

× RED FLAG

```
"Sign to claim your free airdrop!"
Wallet shows: Permit
Spender: 0x7a3…e91
Amount: Unlimited USDT
```

Read every request in 5 checks

1. **The site.** Does the domain in the pop-up match the site you meant to visit, letter for letter?
2. **The action.** Look for words like **Approve, Permit, setApprovalForAll, Transfer, Increase allowance**. Did you expect that?
3. **The preview.** Many wallets now show what will leave and enter your wallet. If assets are leaving and you only expected to receive, stop.
4. **The pressure.** Countdowns and "last chance" exist to stop you thinking.
5. **The device.** On a hardware wallet, read the device screen, not just the website.

Can't understand it? Don't sign it. A real opportunity will still be there after you check.

PART 5

Drainer links & fake DMs

Scammers rarely break in. They get you to open the door.

A **drainer** is a fake site that copies a real project (a mint page, a claim page, an "airdrop checker", a "migration" or "wallet sync") and asks for approvals or signatures that empty your wallet. It can look identical to the real thing.

How drainer links reach you

HACKED ACCOUNTS
A real project's X or Discord gets taken over and posts a "surprise mint" or "claim now".

REPLY GUYS
Lookalike accounts reply under real posts with "claim here" links or fake support offers.

SEARCH ADS
Sponsored results for fake wallet or app sites, sitting above the real one.

LOOKALIKE DOMAINS
One letter changed, an extra dash, or a different ending like .app instead of .io.

Fake support & admin DMs

Most real teams and mods **never DM you first**. If someone slides into your DMs offering help, assume it's a scam until proven otherwise. Common scripts:

- *"I saw your question in #support. Open a ticket here."* (with a link outside the server)
- *"Your wallet is flagged / out of sync. Validate it now."*
- *"You won the giveaway / whitelist! Claim in 24 hours."*
- *"I'm an admin. Share your screen and I'll fix it."*
- *"We'd love to hire you. Test our game / app first."* (a download that steals wallets)

Protect yourself

• Get links only from the project's **official website, docs or verified bio**, and bookmark them.
• Check big announcements on **two official channels** before acting.
• In each Discord server's privacy settings, **turn off DMs** from server members.
• Check roles and usernames **inside the server**. Display names and profile pictures are easy to copy.
• Never download files from strangers, even for a "job" or "beta test".
• Block and report. Then warn the mods so they can warn others.

Mods and community managers: pin a clear "We will never DM you first" message and repeat it often. It's the cheapest scam protection your community will ever get.

PART 6

Fake airdrops & address poisoning

Two scams that show up inside your own wallet.

Fake airdrops

Random tokens or NFTs appear in your wallet, often with a website in the name like *"Claim rewards at xyz-bonus.com"*. They're bait. Visiting the site, or trying to sell the token, can lead you into a drainer approval.

DO

- Ignore them
- Hide them in your wallet app
- Check real airdrops on the project's official channels

DON'T

- Visit the link in the token name
- Try to sell, swap or send it
- Pay a "fee" to unlock a reward

How real airdrops work

They're announced on the project's official channels. You never need to pay a fee to unlock them, and you never need to share your seed phrase.

Address poisoning

Wallet addresses are long, so most people only check the first and last few characters. Scammers use that. They create an address that **starts and ends like one you use**, then send you a tiny or zero-value transfer so it shows up in your history. Next time you copy an address from your history, you might copy theirs.

```
Your friend: 0x9A4f3c81d07e52b6a9…e047C2d
Scammer:     0x9A4fe17b5a20c9d3f8…b117C2d
```

(Example addresses, shortened. Same start, same end, different middle.)

How to stay safe

1. **Never copy addresses from your transaction history.** Copy from the source, or save trusted ones in your wallet's address book.
2. **Check the whole address**, including the middle, after you paste. Some malware swaps copied addresses on your clipboard.
3. **Send a small test first** for big amounts, and confirm it arrived.
4. **Ignore strange tiny transfers** from addresses that look almost like yours or a friend's.

PART 7

Burner wallets & the checklist

Keep risk away from what matters, and slow down before you connect.

Use a burner wallet for mints

A **burner** is a separate wallet that holds almost nothing. If a mint site turns out to be a drainer, it can only take what's in the burner.

1. **Create a new wallet**, ideally with its own seed phrase. (A second account under the same phrase protects you from bad signatures, but not from a leaked phrase.)
2. **Send only what you need**: the mint price plus a little gas.
3. **Mint, claim or test** using the burner only.
4. **Move anything valuable** to your vault, using an address you saved earlier.
5. **Never connect your vault** to the new site. Revoke the burner's approvals when you're done.

Also great for quests, testnets, airdrop campaigns and trying any app for the first time.

Before you connect: the checklist

- [ ] I got the link from the official website, docs or verified bio, not a DM, reply or ad.
- [ ] The web address is spelled exactly right, letter by letter.
- [ ] The news appears on at least two official channels.
- [ ] I'm using my burner wallet for anything new.
- [ ] Nobody is asking for my seed phrase (if they are: leave).
- [ ] I know what the pop-up is: connect, sign or transaction.
- [ ] The domain shown in my wallet matches the site.
- [ ] The preview shows what I expect to send and receive.
- [ ] Any approval is capped at what I need.
- [ ] Nobody is rushing me with a countdown or "last chance".

PART 8

If you get compromised

Unknown transactions, approvals you didn't make, tokens leaving? Act fast, in this order.

1. **Stop and disconnect.** Don't sign anything else. Close the suspicious site.
2. **Work out what leaked**, then follow the right path below.

PATH A

I signed a bad approval or signature

Your seed phrase is still private.

1. Revoke the bad approvals on revoke.cash right away.
2. Move the rest to a safe wallet.
3. Use the old wallet only after you're sure what happened, or retire it.

PATH B

My seed phrase or key leaked

Revoking won't help. The wallet is burned for good.

1. On a clean device, create a brand-new wallet with a new phrase.
2. Move what's left there, most valuable first.
3. Never use the old wallet again.

Watch out for sweeper bots

When a seed phrase is stolen, scammers often run bots that grab any gas you send to the old wallet within seconds. Move quickly, and don't keep feeding it funds.

Then lock everything down

3. **Check your device.** If you recently downloaded a file or extension from a stranger, assume malware. Clean or reset the device before using a wallet on it again.
4. **Secure your accounts.** Change passwords for email, X, Discord and exchanges. Turn on 2FA with an authenticator app and log out other sessions.
5. **Report it.** Tell the project's mods so they can warn others. Report the fake site and accounts. If funds went to an exchange, contact that exchange's support with the transaction links. Consider a police report for your records.

Beware "recovery" scammers

After a hack, you'll get DMs from people who say they can recover your funds for a fee. Treat them as scammers. They target people who just lost money.

PART 9 · SCREENSHOT THIS

The one-page cheat sheet

VAULT
Savings. Cold. Rarely connects.

DAILY
Small amounts. Trusted apps.

BURNER
Mints, airdrops, new sites.

SEED PHRASE

- Paper or metal, two safe places
- No screenshots, cloud or chats
- Never typed into a website
- Anyone asking = scammer

BEFORE YOU SIGN

- Domain matches, letter by letter
- Know the action: approve, permit, transfer
- Preview shows what you expect
- No gas ≠ safe. Unsure? Don't sign

APPROVALS

- Cap the amount when you can
- Check revoke.cash monthly
- Revoke anything you don't use
- Revoke fast after any hack news

LINKS & DMS

- Links from official site or bio only
- Mods never DM first
- Turn off DMs in servers
- No downloads from strangers

IN YOUR WALLET

- Random tokens = bait, ignore
- Never pay to "unlock" airdrops
- Never copy from tx history
- Check the full address; test first

IF YOU'RE HIT

- Stop signing, disconnect
- Bad approval: revoke, then move
- Leaked phrase: new wallet, move fast
- Ignore "recovery" DMs

Not financial advice. For education only. Always do your own research.

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